

Snowy sheathbill
(*Chionis albus*)
Length: 1 ft 4 in (41 cm)

Sheathbills fly well, although they spend most of their time on the ground.

Snowy sheathbill

The snowy, or pale-faced, sheathbill has a varied diet which changes with the seasons. In winter, it eats dead fish, shrimplike krill, and limpets on the shoreline. In summer, it lurks near seal and penguin colonies and feeds on seal dung, weak or injured young seals and penguins, and penguin eggs. It also picks up food scraps from the trash dumps of the many scientific bases that are in Antarctica.

Emperor penguin
(*Aptenodytes forsteri*)
Length: 3 ft 6 in (1 m 10 cm)



Emperor penguin

The enormous emperor penguin comes ashore at the start of the dark Antarctic winter and walks far inland to its nesting colonies, called rookeries. The female lays one large egg, then returns to the sea to feed. For about eight weeks, the male rests the egg on his feet and covers it with a flap of skin from his abdomen to keep it warm. During these freezing cold months, the male cannot eat and hardly moves. The female returns when the egg is due to hatch.



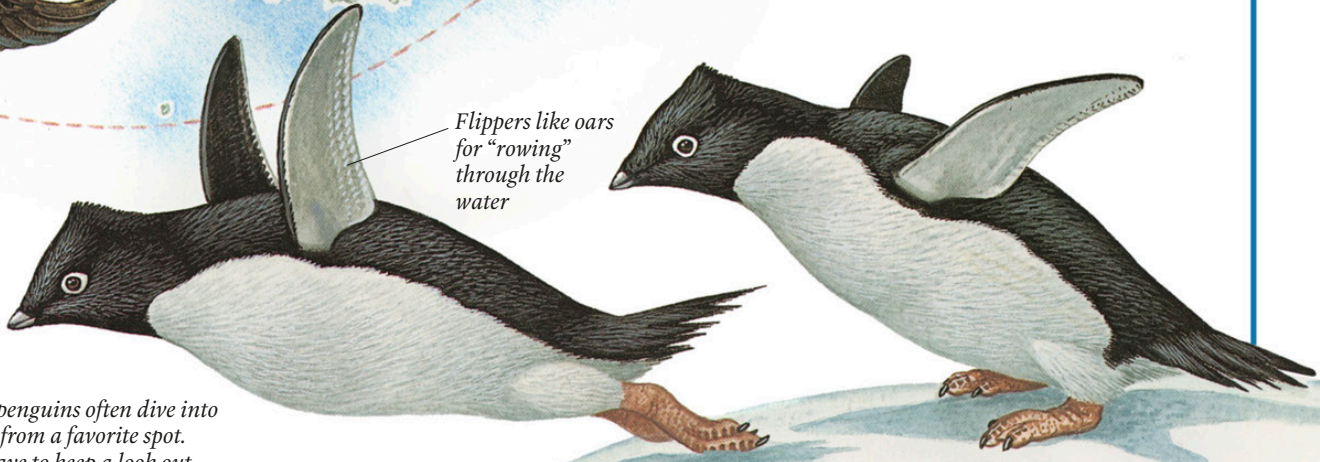
This is a young bird. Adults are mottled gray on the head, face, and underparts.

Southern giant petrel
(*Macronectes giganteus*)
Length: 3 ft 3 in (1 m)

Southern giant petrel

Southern giant petrels or southern giant fulmars are nicknamed "stinkers" because of their unpleasant smell and because they feed on dead animals, such as seals and whales. Like vultures, they use their massive bills to rip open the bodies of dead animals. Giant petrels also kill other petrels, penguins, and albatrosses with their powerful, hooked bills.

Flippers like oars for "rowing" through the water



Adélie penguins often dive into the sea from a favorite spot. They have to keep a look out for leopard seals, which try to catch and eat them.

Adélie penguin
(*Pygoscelis adeliae*)
Length: 2 ft 4 in (71 cm)

Adélie penguin

Adélie and emperor penguins are the only two penguins that live and breed on the continent of Antarctica. In spring, Adélie penguins march inland from the sea to their rookeries. These may contain over a million birds. To mate, the birds usually return to the same rookery where they were born. They greet their mates with a special courtship display, stretching their heads and necks up, beating their wings, and making drumming and braying calls.

